# Alper Şükrü Gençer

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## Education

**New York University**, New York, NY
2021-Present: Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science (expected May 2027)
- Fields: Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methods.
- Cumulative GPA: 3.89/4.00.
- Dissertation Committee: Prof. Cyrus Samii (Chair), Prof. Gwyneth McClendon, Prof. Michael Gilligan, Prof. Sevgi Yüksel

**Washington University in St. Louis**, Saint Louis, MO
2019-2021: M.A., Political Science,
- Fields: Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methods, Formal Theory.
- Cumulative GPA: 3.96/4.00.

**Koç University,** Istanbul, TURKEY
2017 - 2019: M.A., Political Science and International Relations,
- Magna Cum Laude: Top 5% of the Graduate School,
- Cumulative GPA: 4.00/4.00.

**Koç University,** Istanbul, TURKEY
2013 - 2017: B.A., Economics,
2011 - 2017: B.A., Political Science,
- Magna Cum Laude: Top 1% of Economics & Political Science,
- Minor in History
- Cumulative GPA: 3.96/4.00.

**Bocconi University**, Milan, ITALY
2014 - 2015: Erasmus Study Abroad Program in Economics.

## Peer-Reviewed Publications

**Yörük, E. & Gençer, A.Ş.** (2022, September). "The dynamics of welfare state regime development in the Global South: Structures, institutions, and political agency." *Journal of Comparative Policy Analysis*. **doi**: 10.1080/13876988.2021.2004541.

**Yörük, E. & Gençer, A.Ş.** (2020, August). "The politics of social assistance in South Africa: How protests and electoral politics shape the Child Support Grant." *Governance*. **doi**: 10.1111/gove.12464.

**Öniş, Z. & Gençer, A.Ş.** (2018, February). "Democratic BRICS as role models in a shifting global order: Inherent dilemmas and the challenges ahead." *Third World Quarterly, 39*(3). **doi**: 10.1080/01436597.2018.1438185.

## Papers Under Review

**Gençer, A.Ş.**. "Rethinking 'Them': Challenging Out-Group Stereotypes in Backsliding Democracies." Under review.

**Gençer, A.Ş.**. "When Do Electoral Power Grabs Increase Support for Election Monitoring? Evidence from a Survey Experiment in Turkey." Under review.

## Working Papers and Ongoing Projects

**Gençer, A.Ş.**. "Unbundling Autocratic Capture: Complexity, Selective Emphasis, and Democratic Accountability." Job Market Paper.

**Gençer, A.Ş. & Samii, C.**. "Optimal Allocation of Compliance Incentives."

**Gençer, A.Ş.**. "From Distinctiveness to Distortion: Predicting Partisan Misperception."

**Gençer, A.Ş.**. "What Does Disaster Risk Buy? Political Allocation and the Composition of Mitigation Investment."

**Gençer, A.Ş.**. "Constrained Accountability after Disaster: Evidence from Turkey's 2023 Earthquakes."

**Gençer, A.Ş. & Civitarese, C.**. "Monitoring, Cognitive Load, and Strategic Omission in Political Communication."

**Gençer, A.Ş., Tafoya, G.R., Yörük, E., & Yoltar, C.**. "Carrots and Sticks: Social Assistance as a Containment Strategy in Brazil."

## Conference Presentations

**2026: Behavioral Models of Politics**
"Unbundling Autocratic Capture"

**2026: NYU Rebecca Morton Experimental Conference**
"Optimal Allocation of Compliance Incentives"

**2025: NYU Data Science Frontiers: Society and Politics**
"Optimal Allocation of Compliance Incentives"

**2025: Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference**
"Rethinking 'Them': Challenging Out-Group Stereotypes in Backsliding Democracies"

**2024: NYU Rebecca Morton Experimental Conference**
"Rethinking 'Them': Challenging Out-Group Stereotypes in Backsliding Democracies"

## Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

**2025 - 2026: APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant**, Washington, DC
- American Political Science Association; $13,343 for "Unbundling Autocratic Capture"

**2025 - 2026: Identities & Ideologies Project (NYU) Research Grant**, New York, NY
- $3,000 for "Measuring Stereotype-Prone Beliefs: Validation of a Representativeness-Based Algorithm"

**2022, 2023, 2025: New York University George Downs Prize**, New York, NY
- Competitive departmental award supporting dissertation research in political science $1,500 (2022), $2,500 (2023), $2,000 (2025)

**2021 - Present: New York University Henry M. MacCracken Fellowship**, New York, NY
- Full tuition and living stipend

**2019 - 2021: Washington University in St. Louis Graduate School Scholarship**, Saint Louis, MO
- Full tuition and living stipend

**2017 - 2019: TÜBİTAK Graduate Scholarship**, Ankara, TURKEY
- 2210A National Scholarship Program for M.Sc. Students

**2017 - 2019: Koç University High Success Scholarship for Graduate Studies**, Istanbul, TURKEY
- Full tuition, housing, and stipend

**2017: Koç University Magna Cum Laude Award**, Istanbul, TURKEY
- Second-highest academic record among Political Science and International Relations graduates

**2014 - 2015: Erasmus Exchange Scholarship, Bocconi University**, ITALY
- Merit-based scholarship covering one semester stipend

**2013 - 2016: Turkish Education Foundation (TEV) Outstanding Success Scholarship**, Istanbul, TURKEY
- Highly competitive national scholarship awarded to 50 students annually

**2011 - 2017: Koç University High Honor Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies**, Istanbul, TURKEY
- Full tuition, housing, and living stipend; awarded to students ranking in the top 1,000 on the national university entrance examination

## Teaching

**New York University,** New York, NY

*Recitation Leader*
- International Politics: Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2026
- Introduction to Comparative Politics: Fall 2024
- Introduction to Research Methods: Spring 2026

*Teaching Assistant*
- Quantitative Methods: Fall 2025

*Quantitative Methods Advisor, Democracy Research Initiative*
- Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026

**Washington University in St. Louis,** Saint Louis, MO

*Teaching Assistant*
- International Politics: Fall 2020
- Quantitative Methods: Spring 2021

## Research Experience

**September 2023 - May 2025: New York University,** New York, NY
*Research Assistant, xmachine*
- Worked under the supervision of Prof. Cyrus Samii and Prof. Michael Gechter
- Collected, cleaned, and managed data from multiple countries and reproduced results from field experiments
- Applied machine-learning methods for out-of-sample prediction and conducted structural estimation
- Developed statistical visualizations and maintained reproducible research workflows in R and Git

**September 2017 - August 2022: Koç University,** Istanbul, TURKEY
*Researcher, Emerging Welfare Project*
- Full-time Researcher and Team Member, September 2017 - August 2019
- Part-time Researcher, September 2019 - August 2022
- Worked on the European Research Council project "Emerging Welfare" under the supervision of Prof. Erdem Yörük
- Conducted quantitative analysis and fieldwork on politics of social assistance, including interviews with state officials, academics, and NGOs
- Coordinated data collection on welfare, social policy, and political and economic indicators
- Contributed to manuscripts on the political determinants of social assistance expansion

**February 2018 - January 2019: Institute of Istanbul Political Research (IstanPol),** Istanbul, TURKEY
*Volunteer Researcher*
- Worked on a project on politics of precariat class and income inequality in Turkey
- Wrote a research paper on perceptions of Syrian child refugees in Turkey

**September 2016 - June 2017: Koç University,** Istanbul, TURKEY
*Research Assistant (RA)*
- Worked under the supervision of Prof. Ziya Öniş
- Conducted literature reviews on the political economy of development and democracy in the Global South
- Published an article on the role model capabilities of the democratic BRICS for the Global South

**September 2016 - December 2017: Political and Social Research Institute of Europe (PS Europe),** Istanbul, TURKEY
*Volunteer Researcher*
- Worked on a project on politics of precariat class and income inequality
- Wrote a research paper on perceptions of asylum seekers, migrants, and refugees in Turkey
- Participated in "Armenia Turkey Dialogue Project," which aimed at establishing a dialogue between Turkish and Armenian academics and civil society activists

## Published Reports

**Gençer, A.Ş. et al.** (2018, October). "From information to perception: The journey of the Syrian "ghost" children in Istanbul." *IstanPol.* **Access**: Link.

**Gençer, A.Ş. et al.** (2017, July). "A study on the perception of asylum-seekers, migrants, and refugees in Turkey." *PS Europe.* **Access**: Link.

## Published Dataset

Yörük, E., Tafoya, G.R., Öker, İ., Bargu, A., **Gençer, A.Ş.**, Çemen, R., Kına, F., Yoltar, Ç., Gürel, B., & Koyuncu, M. (2019). "Global Welfare Dataset, Version 2019." *EMW Project.* **Access**: Link

## Research Interests

Democratic Backsliding, Political Accountability, Political Behavior; Information Processing, Affective Polarization, Authoritarian Politics; Survey and Field Experiments, Causal Inference, Experimental Design

## Languages and Skills

Turkish (native), English (fluent), French (Intermediate), Arabic (Intermediate)
R (advanced), LaTeX (advanced), Python (intermediate), Stata (intermediate), GitHub

## References


**Prof. Gwyneth McClendon**
Dept. of Politics
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Dissertation Advisor

**Prof. Cyrus Samii**
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Dissertation Chair

**Prof. Michael Gilligan**
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Dissertation Advisor